economic policy (NEP) made the experts and economists to conclude many questionable things about the objectives of planning in the country:

(i) There did hd on the wage employments still, others based on self-employment.

(ii) The state is rolling back and the economy is becoming pro-private and sector-wise the social purpose of the planning will be lacking.

(iii) The objectives of planning nearly outlined hitherto have been blurred.

(iv) The promotion of foreign investment will induce the economy into the perils of neo-imperialism, etc.

But all the above-given doubts were cleared by the forthcoming plans in straightforward words. We may quote from the following Plans:

(i) "For the future economic development, the economy will be more dependent upon private participation and the nature of planning will become more indicative with the major objectives of planning remaining the same". This was announced by the Government while launching the economic reforms (July 23, 1991) and commencing the Eighth five-year Plan (1992–97). "There was no change in the basic objectives of planning even though there was change in instruments of policy"—this was announced by the Government while announcing the new economic policy (1991).

(ii) While the Ninth Plan (1997–2002) was being launched it was announced, "The goals of planning in India, which were set by Panditji have not changed. The Ninth Plan does not attempt to reinvent the wheel. At the same time, the goals and targets this Plan attempts to achieve are based on the lessons of experience including the Eighth Plan. They address today's problems and challenges and try to prepare the nation for tomorrow as well."[34]

Finally, a broad consensus looks evolving through the process of planning and crystallising on the six major objectives of planning[35] in India which are as follows:

(i) **Economic Growth:** Sustained increase in the levels of production in the economy is among the foremost objectives of planning in